

- (c) Sakri
- (d) Balan
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

63rd B.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

The Punpun river originates from the Chota Nagpur Plateau state of Jharkhand and enters the Aurangabad district of Bihar and joining the Ganges near Fatuha in the Patna district.

45. The average height of the Kosi Plain from mean sea level is:

- (a) 300 m
- (b) 150 m
- (c) 30 m
- (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre), 2023

Ans. (c)

The Kosi Plain is in Bihar. The triangular plain's opening is located at Birpur (54m), near the border with Nepal. The base runs parallel to river Ganga from Khagaria (36m) to Kursela (25m). Significantly a little area's elevation in upper plan is below 50m. The average elevation in the basin is between 30m and 40m; general slope is from northwest to southeast.

Only option (c) (30m) reflects correct answer.

46. Average height of Kosi Plain from mean sea level is:

- (a) 100 m
- (b) 30 m
- (c) 150 m
- (d) 300 m

70th B.P.S.C Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (b)

The Kosi Plain or Basin has an average elevation of approximately 30–40 meters above sea level. In India, the Kosi Plain is part of the lower Ganga Plain. Its general slope is from northwest to southeast. Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

47. Which drainage pattern is commonly found in Ganga plains and Assam Valley, characterized by wide plains, gentle slopes, heavy rains and large number of tributaries?

- (a) Antecedent drainage pattern
- (b) Dendritic drainage pattern
- (c) Radial drainage pattern
- (d) Rectangular drainage pattern

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

The Ganga-Brahmaputra river system and the Assam Valley, Sindhu river system, Mahanadi and Godavari generally exhibit a dendritic drainage pattern, characterized by wide plains, gentle slopes, heavy rainfall and numerous tributaries. This pattern is known as the dendritic drainage pattern. It develops in areas where there is no specific structure in the underlying rocks, allowing the streams to spread evenly in all directions. In this pattern, tributaries join the main river at low angles.

ii. Brahmaputra Drainage System

*The river Brahmaputra originates from the Angsi Glacier near the Mansarovar Lake. Here it is known as '**Yarlung Tsangpo**'. It flows parallel to the eastward side of the Himalayas. It takes a '**U**' shaped turn at '**Namcha Barwa**' peak to enter in India. It enters India west of **Sadiya town** in Assam under the name of **Siang** or **Dihang**. Flowing onward, it meets its main left bank tributaries i.e. **Dibang** or **Sikang** and **Lohit** and thereafter it is known as the **Brahmaputra**.

*Its major left bank tributaries in the Assam valley are the **Burhi Dihing** and **Dhansiri** whereas the important right bank tributaries are the **Subansiri**, **Jiabharali**, **Manas**, and **Sankosh**.

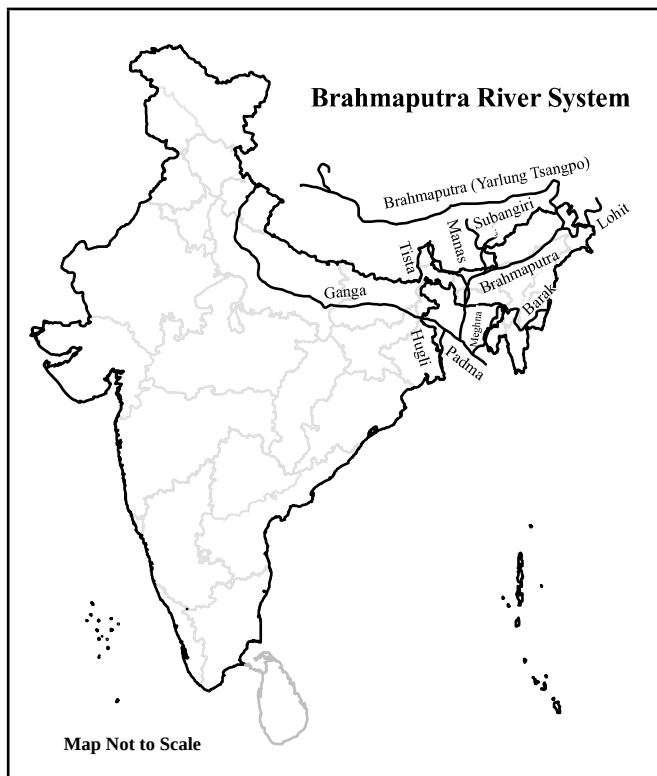
*The Brahmaputra enters Bangladesh near **Dhubri**. *In Bangladesh, the **Tista** joins it on its right bank where the river is known as the **Jamuna**.

*It finally merges with the river Padma, which flows into the Bay of Bengal.

*The Brahmaputra has a braided channel along its entire length in Assam and forms many riverine islands. **Majuli**, the biggest riverine island in the world, is also the first island district of the country, located on the Brahmaputra River in Assam.

***The Brahmaputra, the Satluj and the Indus** rivers have their sources of origin near **Mansarovar lake** in Tibet.

*The Tibetan Plateau is also known as the **Qinghai - Tibet Plateau** or the **Qing - Zang Plateau**. It is also called as the '**Roof of the World**'. (Note - The metaphor Roof of the World usually refers to the mountainous interior of Asia, including the Pamirs, the Himalayas, the Tibet, the Tian Shan, and the Altai Mountains.) The Tibetan Plateau is the source of Asia's major rivers such as Yangtze river, Huang He river, Indus river, Satluj river, Brahmaputra river, Mekong river and Salween river.



1. The Brahmaputra, Irrawaddy and Mekong Rivers originate in Tibet narrow and flow in parallel mountain ranges in their upper reaches. Of these rivers, Brahmaputra makes a “U” turn in its course to flow into India. This “U” turn is due to ?

- Uplift of folded Himalayan ranges.
- Syntaxial bending of geologically young Himalayas.
- Geo-tectonic disturbance in the tertiary folded mountain chains.
- Both (a) and (b) above.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

The Himalayan mountains on their western and eastern extremities are sharply bent southward in deep knee-bend flexures that are called syntaxial bends. An almost hairpin bend occurs on the eastern limit of Arunachal Pradesh, where the mountains change sharply from an easterly to a southerly trend.

2. In India, 'Yarlung Zangbo River' is known as

- Ganga
- Indus
- Brahmaputra
- Mahanadi

B.P.S.C. 56th to 59th (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Yarlung Zangbo is known as the Brahmaputra river in India. It originates at Angsi glacier in western Tibet.

3. Near Mansarovar lake in Tibet, there is the source of the river –

- Brahmaputra
- Satluj
- Indus
- All the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The source of river Brahmaputra, Indus, and Sutlej (Satluj), is near Mansarovar Lake in Tibet.

4. Consider the following rivers :

- Barak
 - Lohit
 - Subansiri
- Which of the above flows/flow through Arunachal Pradesh?

- 1 only
- 2 and 3 only
- 1 and 3 only
- 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

Lohit and Subansiri rivers flow through Arunachal Pradesh while Barak river flows from its source in the Manipur Hills, through border between Manipur - Nagaland and Assam. The Subansiri river originates in Tibet; it is a tributary of the Brahmaputra river. It flows through the Indian states of Assam and Arunachal Pradesh, as well as the Tibet Autonomous Region of China. The Lohit river rises in eastern Tibet, in the Zayal Chu Range. It is also a tributary of the Brahmaputra river.

5. Manas is the tributary of river :

- Godavari
- Mahanadi
- Krishna
- Brahmaputra

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

Manas is a tributary of Brahmaputra river. Other major tributaries of Brahmaputra are – Tista, Kameng, Subansiri, Dhansari, Burhi Dihing, Dibang, and Kopili. The Brahmaputra is known as Tsangpo or Sanpu in Tibet, Dihang in Arunachal Pradesh, Brahmaputra in Assam and Jamuna in Bangladesh. Brahmaputra river flows through Tibet region of China, India, and Bangladesh.

6. In Tibet, Brahmaputra river is known as ?

- Padma
- Chakmudung
- Himjug
- Tsangpo

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

7. The catchment area of river Brahmaputra is –

- Tibet, Bangladesh, India
- India, China, Bangladesh, Tibet

- (c) India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Sikkim
(d) Bangladesh, West Bengal, Bhutan, Nepal.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (a)

The catchment area of the river Brahmaputra is Tibet (China), Bangladesh, India and Bhutan.

8. Majuli, is the largest inhabited riverine island in the World is formed by:

- (a) Ganga river (b) Narmada river
(c) Brahmaputra river (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. Which of the following Manganese producing area is not located in Karnataka?

- (a) Shimoga (b) Bellary
(c) Srikakulam (d) Chikmagalur

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Shimoga, Ballari and Chikkamagaluru are Manganese producing areas of Karnataka, while Srikakulam is a district in Andhra Pradesh, which is mainly known for the production of quartz, feldspar and other ferro-magnesium minerals. According to the Indian Minerals Yearbook 2022, the three largest manganese producing states in Year 2021-22 are Madhya Pradesh (21.50%), Maharashtra (27%) and Odisha (19%) respectively.

10. Which of the following is/are tributary/tributaries of Brahmaputra?

1. Dibang 2. Kameng
3. Lohit

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

The tributaries of Brahmaputra river are Kameng, Sankosh, Jiabharali, Manas,, Dibang, Lohit, and Burhi Dihing rivers. Thus all the given tributaries are correct. Dibang river flows across Dibang Valley district and Lower Dibang Valley district of Arunachal Pradesh, Kameng river flows in Arunachal Pradesh and Assam while the Lohit river originates in eastern Tibet and flows through Arunachal Pradesh and Assam.

11. With reference to river Teesta, consider the following statements :

- The source of river Teesta is the same as that of Brahmaputra but it flows through Sikkim.
- River Rangeet originates in Sikkim and it is a tributary of river Teesta.
- River Teesta flows into Bay of Bengal on the border of India and Bangladesh.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

The Teesta River originates from the Khangchung Chho glacial lake in Sikkim as Chhonbo Chhu river at an altitude of approx. 5280 meters. The source of the Brahmaputra River is the Angsi Glaciar in Tibet. Thus statement (1) is wrong. River Rangeet originates in Sikkim and it is a tributary of river Teesta. Thus statement (2) is correct. Teesta river is a tributary of Brahmaputra. Teesta River flows through Sikkim and West Bengal in India. It joins Brahmaputra in Bangladesh and falls into the Bay of Bengal. Thus statement (3) is wrong. Hence option (b) is correct answer.

12. Which of the following rivers have almost the same point of the beginning?

- (a) Brahmaputra and Ganga
(b) Tapi and Beas
(c) Brahmaputra and Indus
(d) Indus and Ganga

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

The Tibetan Plateau is also known in China as the Qinghai-Tibet Plateau or the Qing Zang. With an average elevation exceeding 4,500 meters, the Tibetan Plateau is also called "the Roof of the World". The rivers originating here are the Yangtze, Huang He (Yellow River), Mekong, Indus, Satlej (Sutlej), Brahmaputra, and Salween. Hence, it is clear that Brahmaputra and Indus originate from the Tibetan Plateau.

13. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and other as Reason (R) :

Assertion (A) : Teesta river was earlier a tributary of Ganga now it is a tributary of Brahmaputra.

Reason (R) : River capturing is a major feature of Himalayan rivers.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.